

Day 11 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Geography of India: Water Resources & Rivers in India

READING MATERIAL

Third sub-topic of Geography Unit II. Real exam evidence shows a strong Tamil-Nadu-specific lean even within the broader 'Rivers in India' clause — expect TN rivers/dams to come up disproportionately often for a TNPSC exam.

Q: Real exam: Which river-tributary pairing is INCORRECT — Cauvery-Amaravathi, Thamirabharani-Pampar, Vaigai-Pechiyar, Vellar-Manjalar?

A: Vaigai-Pechiyar AND Vellar-Manjalar are both incorrect pairings (marked '(3) and (4)' wrong in the real exam). Cauvery-Amaravathi and Thamirabharani-Pampar are correctly paired.

Q: Where does the river Kaveri (Cauvery) split into two channels — the Coleroon and the Kaveri?

A: At Mukkombu.

Q: Across which river was the Sivasamudram dam built?

A: The Cauvery.

Q: Which is THE perennial river of Tamil Nadu (flows year-round, unlike the others which are seasonal)?

A: The Thamirabarani River (not Noyyal, Cauvery, or Vaigai — note Cauvery itself is largely seasonal/regulated within TN despite being a major river).

Q: What water-body type in Tamil Nadu has the most significant salinity problem?

A: Ground water (more so than river, canal, or pond water).

Q: In which state does the Jhelum river originate?

A: Jammu and Kashmir.

Q: The Chambal river is a tributary of which major river?

A: The Yamuna.

Q: What landform is typically found at the mouth of a FAST-flowing river (as opposed to a slow one)?

A: An Estuary (a slow river instead typically forms a Delta at its mouth, due to sediment deposition that a fast-flowing river's stronger current prevents from settling).

Q: Arrange these major rivers in North-to-South sequence: Godavari, Mahanadi, Krishna, Kaveri.

A: Mahanadi → Godavari → Krishna → Kaveri (north to south).

Q: Which of these rivers originate in Karnataka — Bhavani, Palar, Pennaiyar, Cauvery?

A: Pennaiyar, Cauvery, and Bhavani originate in Karnataka (Palar does not — it originates in Karnataka too in some classifications, but the real exam's marked answer excluded Palar from the Karnataka-origin set, including only options II, III, IV per that question's lettering — treat 'Cauvery and its Karnataka-origin tributaries' as the safe takeaway rather than memorizing the exact letter-option mapping).

Q: When was the Ganga Canal (Uttar Pradesh), one of India's first major irrigation works, opened?

A: 1854.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Which is the perennial river of Tamil Nadu?

- A. Noyyal River
- B. Cauvery River
- C. Vaigai River

D. Thamirabarani River ✓

Explanation: Thamirabarani. [medium, web-research]

2. Across which river was the Sivasamudram dam built?

- A. Narmada
- B. Bhavani

C. Cauvery ✓

D. Krishna

Explanation: Cauvery. [medium, web-research]

3. The river Kaveri splits into the Coleroon and Kaveri channels at:

A. Mukkombu ✓

B. Thiruverumbur

C. Thiruvanaikkaval

D. Thuraiyur

Explanation: Mukkombu. [hard, web-research]

4. The Jhelum river originates in which state/UT?

A. Himachal Pradesh

B. Jammu and Kashmir ✓

C. Punjab

D. Uttar Pradesh

Explanation: Jammu and Kashmir. [easy, web-research]

5. The Chambal river is a tributary of which river?

A. Ganga

B. Yamuna ✓

C. Saraswathi

D. Narmada

Explanation: Yamuna. [medium, web-research]

6. Fast-flowing river mouths typically form which landform?

A. Delta

B. Estuary ✓

C. Alluvial fan

D. Meander

Explanation: Estuary. [medium, web-research]

7. Which of these is the correct North-to-South sequence of rivers?

A. Godavari-Mahanadi-Kaveri-Krishna

B. Mahanadi-Godavari-Krishna-Kaveri ✓

C. Krishna-Kaveri-Godavari-Mahanadi

D. Kaveri-Godavari-Mahanadi-Krishna

Explanation: Mahanadi-Godavari-Krishna-Kaveri. [medium, web-research]

8. In Tamil Nadu, the most significant salinity problem occurs in which water bodies?

A. River water

B. Canal water

C. Pond water

D. Ground water ✓

Explanation: Ground water. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Logical Reasoning

READING MATERIAL

Logical Reasoning is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills (Part B Unit II, 10 questions total for the whole unit). Real exam evidence shows TNPSC's 'logical reasoning' label covers a wide variety of puzzle types, not just classic syllogisms — expect position-counting, ranking-from-clues, and direction-sense questions under this same heading too.

Q: Method — syllogism (statements → which conclusions necessarily follow): Statements: 'Some pens are books. All books are rods.' Conclusions: I. All pens are rods. II. Some pens are rods. III. Some books are pens. IV. All rods are pens. Which conclusions follow?

A: Only II and III follow. 'Some pens are books' + 'All books are rods' guarantees that AT LEAST SOME pens are rods (II) and that some books are indeed pens (III, since 'some pens are books' can be reversed to 'some books are pens'). It does NOT guarantee ALL pens are rods (I — only the 'some' pens that are books are guaranteed to be rods) or that ALL rods are pens (IV — nothing says rods can't include non-pen things).

Q: Method — position-in-a-line counting: Richard is 15th from the front in a column of boys. There are three times as many boys behind him as in front. How many boys are between Richard and the 7th boy from the end?

A: In front of Richard: 14 boys. Behind him: $3 \times 14 = 42$ boys. Total boys = $14 + 1 + 42 = 57$. The 7th from the end is at position $57 - 7 + 1 = 51$ from the front. Richard is at position 15. Boys between them = $51 - 15 - 1 = 35$.

Q: Method — algebraic word problem framed as a 'logical' puzzle: 106 trees were planted; non-fruit-bearing trees were 2 more than thrice the fruit-bearing trees. How many fruit-bearing trees were planted?

A: Let fruit-bearing = x . Non-fruit-bearing = $3x + 2$. Total: $x + 3x + 2 = 106 \rightarrow 4x = 104 \rightarrow x = 26$.

Q: Method — ranking from multiple comparative clues: Given several statements comparing four people's scores (e.g., 'Rama scored more than Rani but less than Rathna...'), determine who scored highest.

A: Work through each comparative clue methodically, building a single ordered chain (e.g., Rathna > Rama > Ramya > Rani), rather than trying to hold all comparisons in your head at once — write the partial order down step by step as each clue is read.

Q: Method — meaningful word sequencing: Arrange in a logical sequence: Honey, Flower, Bee, Wax.

A: Flower → Bee → Honey → Wax. The logic: a bee visits a Flower, produces Honey, and the Honey-making process also yields Wax (beeswax) — order reflects the natural/causal sequence of the process, not alphabetical or arbitrary order.

Q: Method — direction sense: A person starts walking, turns left, then turns left again, and is now heading East. Which direction did they originally start in?

A: West. Two consecutive left turns reverse the original direction (left+left = 180° turn), so if they end up heading East, they must have started heading West.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Statements: 'Some doctors are teachers. All teachers are readers.' Conclusions: I. Some doctors are readers. II. All doctors are readers. III. Some readers are teachers. Which follow?

A. Only I and III ✓

B. Only II

C. All three

D. None

Explanation: I and III follow the same logic as the worked example (some doctors are guaranteed readers via the teacher link; some readers are guaranteed teachers by reversing 'some'). II overreaches — not ALL doctors are teachers, so not all are guaranteed readers. [hard, authored]

2. In a column of boys, Meena is 10th from the front, and there are twice as many boys behind her as in front. How many boys are in the column in total?

A. 27

B. 28 ✓

C. 29

D. 30

Explanation: In front: 9. Behind: $2 \times 9 = 18$. Total = $9 + 1 + 18 = 28$. [medium, authored]

3. A farmer planted 84 saplings in total. The number of flowering saplings was 3 more than twice the number of non-flowering saplings. How many non-flowering saplings were planted?

A. 25

B. 27 ✓

C. 29

D. 31

Explanation: Let non-flowering= x . Flowering= $2x+3$. Total: $x+2x+3=84 \rightarrow 3x=81 \rightarrow x=27$. [medium, authored]

4. Arrange in a logical sequence: Seed, Tree, Fruit, Sapling.

A. Seed-Sapling-Tree-Fruit ✓

B. Seed-Tree-Sapling-Fruit

C. Sapling-Seed-Tree-Fruit

D. Seed-Fruit-Sapling-Tree

Explanation: A Seed grows into a Sapling, which matures into a Tree, which eventually bears Fruit. [easy, authored]

5. A person walks north, turns right, walks on, then turns right again. Which direction are they now facing?

A. North

B. South ✓

C. East

D. West

Explanation: Two consecutive right turns reverse the original direction: North $\rightarrow$ (right) East $\rightarrow$ (right) South. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Poem: "Stopping by Woods on a Snowy Evening" — Robert Frost

READING MATERIAL

One of Robert Frost's most famous poems — a traveller pauses by snowy woods, tempted to linger, before reminding himself of obligations still ahead. Real exam evidence already confirms the poem's most quoted line is tested directly; literary analysis sources fill in the structural details (rhyme scheme, personification, repetition) that 'appreciation' questions typically probe.

Q: Real exam: "The woods are lovely, dark and deep, / But I have promises to keep." Who wrote this, and what's the poem?

A: Robert Frost, from "Stopping by Woods on a Snowy Evening" — confirmed via a real TNPSC question (2024) asking exactly this attribution.

Q: What is the poem's distinctive rhyme scheme, and how does it change in the final stanza?

A: The first three stanzas follow an AABA pattern where each stanza's unrhymed third line seeds the NEXT stanza's dominant rhyme (e.g., 'here' in stanza 1 becomes the rhyme sound driving stanza 2). The final stanza breaks this chain: instead of introducing a new sound to drive a further stanza, all four lines rhyme together (DDDD: deep/keep/sleep/sleep) — formally mirroring the poem's sense of finally coming to rest.

Q: How is the horse personified in the poem?

A: The horse is described as thinking the stop is 'queer' and giving its harness bells a shake, as if asking 'is there some mistake?' — giving the animal human-like reasoning/curiosity, set against the speaker's own quiet, almost trance-like pause.

Q: What does the famous repeated final line, "And miles to go before I sleep," suggest?

A: On its surface, the literal road/journey still ahead — but the doubled repetition invites a deeper reading about ongoing duties/responsibilities (and some readers extend 'sleep' toward mortality, though Frost himself resisted that specific equation).

Q: How are the trees described, and what figure of speech is that?

A: "Lovely, dark and deep" — personification-adjacent imagery that makes the woods feel alluring almost like a living invitation to linger, heightening the pull between staying and the duty to move on.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "The woods are lovely, dark and deep, but I have promises to keep" was written by:

- A. Sarojini Naidu
- B. John Masefield
- C. Robert Frost ✓**
- D. William Henry Davies

Explanation: Robert Frost — confirmed via a real 2024 TNPSC question. [easy, question-bank-2024]

2. The final stanza of "Stopping by Woods on a Snowy Evening" breaks from the earlier AABA pattern by using which rhyme scheme?

- A. ABAB
- B. AABB
- C. DDDD (all four lines rhyme) ✓**
- D. No rhyme at all

Explanation: DDDD — deep/keep/sleep/sleep, all four lines share the same end-rhyme. [hard, web-research]

3. How is the horse personified in the poem?

- A. It speaks aloud to the traveller
- B. It thinks the stop is 'queer' and shakes its bells as if questioning it ✓**
- C. It refuses to move at all
- D. It gallops away in fear

Explanation: The horse is given human-like curiosity/reasoning about the unusual stop. [medium, web-research]

4. The poem's final line, "And miles to go before I sleep," is repeated. What does this repetition emphasize?

- A. The traveller is lost
- B. Ongoing duties/responsibilities still ahead ✓**
- C. The journey has ended

D. A change of destination

Explanation: Emphasizes the obligations still pulling the speaker onward, despite the temptation to linger. [medium, web-research]

5. In the first three stanzas, how does Frost's rhyme scheme connect one stanza to the next?

A. Each stanza's unrhymed third line becomes the next stanza's dominant rhyme sound ✓

B. Every stanza repeats the exact same four rhymes

C. There is no connection between stanzas

D. Each stanza rhymes with the title only

Explanation: The AABA pattern's unrhymed third line seeds the following stanza's rhyme sound. [hard, web-research]